Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) — Employee Handbook

What sexual harassment looks like under the POSH Act 2013, everyone's rights, how to complain, and what the Internal Committee does.

REF	KB-E-18
VERSION	V2.6
EFFECTIVE	01 DEC 2025
FOR	ALL EMPLOYEES
CLASSIFICATION	INTERNAL / ALL EMPLOYEES

Emids Technologies maintains a workplace free of sexual harassment as required under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. This handbook is written for every employee and intern; it is a legal compliance document, re-issued annually with awareness training.

1. What counts as sexual harassment

Under the Act, any one of these unwelcome acts or behaviour (directly or by implication) is sexual harassment: physical contact and advances; a demand or request for sexual favours; making sexually coloured remarks; showing pornography; or any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

- It is about the impact on the recipient, not the intent of the person doing it.
- It covers online conduct — chats, video calls, social messages, shared media.
- It applies at the office, client sites, work events, and any context that is sufficiently connected to work.
- Both women and men can experience and complain of unwelcome conduct; the Act's statutory committee process gives additional statutory rights in certain cases.

2. Your rights

- A workplace free from harassment — including from clients, vendors and visitors, not only Emids colleagues.
- A specified Internal Committee process with defined timelines, confidentiality and no cost to you.
- Interim relief measures (work transfer to avoid contact, up to 3 months' paid leave where warranted by law) while an inquiry continues.
- No retaliation — for complaining, being a witness, or helping an inquiry.

3. Who to complain to

The Internal Committee (IC) at each office is the statutory forum. Its member roster, including an external member, is displayed on notice boards and the HR portal. You may approach any IC member directly, email the IC mailbox, or raise through the HR portal marked confidential. Complaints of this kind made through ordinary HR tickets are routed automatically and unread to the IC.

4. The inquiry process at a glance

Step	Timeline
Complaint filed (written, to any member)	Within 3 months of the incident (extensions possible)
IC acknowledgement & interim measures	7 days
Respondent gets copy + reply window	10 days
Inquiry with both sides heard	≤ 90 days
IC report & recommendation to employer	10 days after inquiry closes
Employer action on recommendations	60 days

5. Confidentiality and false complaints

Names, details and documents in an IC process are confidential — publishing them further is itself punishable. Complaints made in good faith are protected even if not proven; complaints proven malicious or knowingly false face disciplinary action.

> If you witness harassment of someone else, you can complain too — the Act lets any affected person's colleague report on their behalf with their consent.